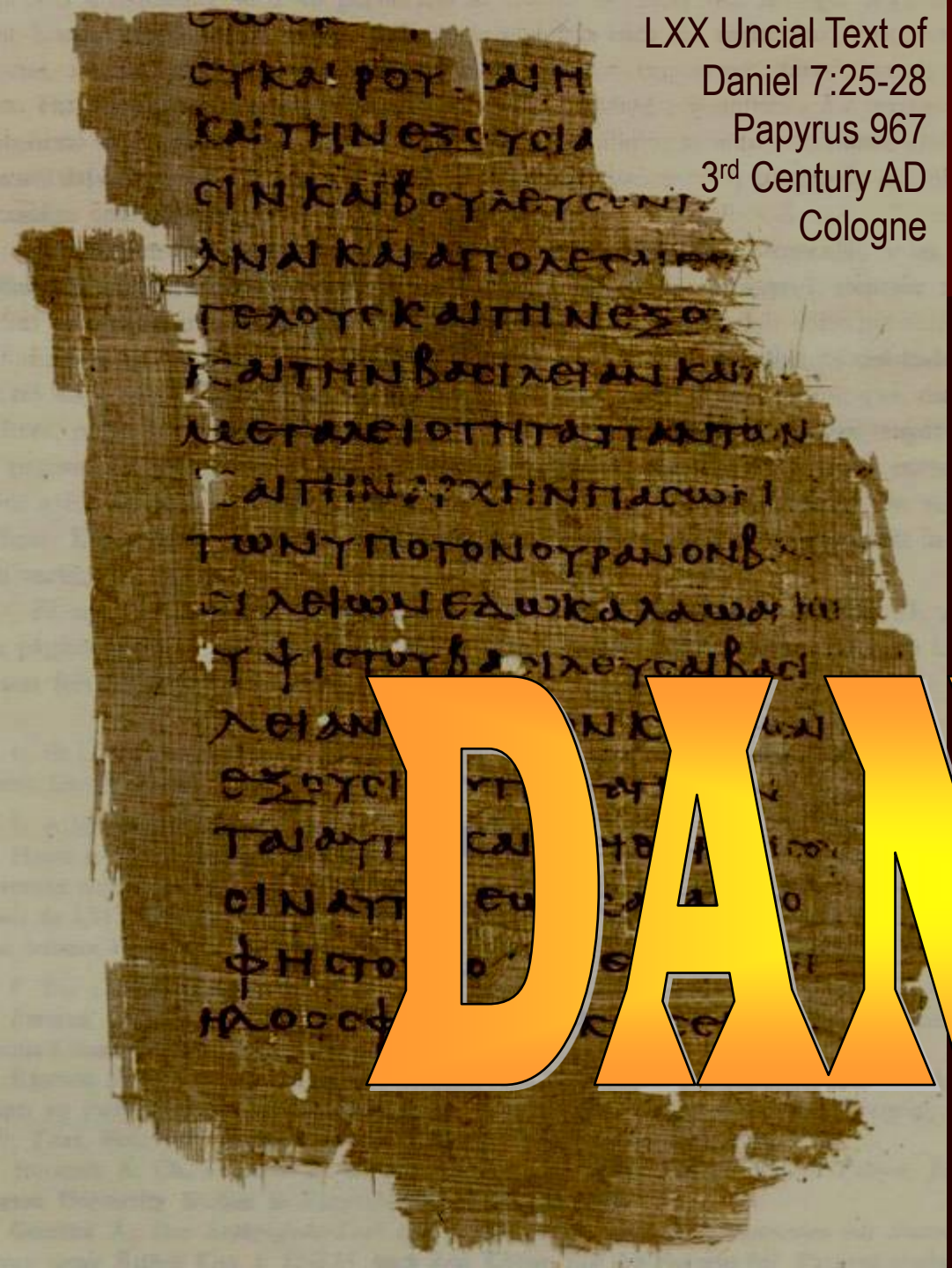

LXX Uncial Text of
Daniel 7:25-28
Papyrus 967
3rd Century AD
Cologne

Book of DANIEL

Daniel Chapters 11 and 12

The Details cont.– Daniel 11:21-30

Antiochus IV Epiphanes (11:21)

Execution of Onias III (11:22-24)

- *Antiochus courts the Jewish elite*
- *171 BC*

Ptolemy VI vs. Antiochus IV (11:25-26)

The two negotiate (11:27)

Antiochus IV interferes in Jewish affairs (11:28)

Antiochus' army thwarted by Roman navy (11:29-30)

- *He vents his frustration on Jerusalem*

Antiochus IV desecrates the temple (11:31-35)

- *Forbids Jewish sacrifice*
- *Outlaws circumcision*
- *Suspends Sabbath observance*
- *Dedicates the temple to Zeus, the abomination of desolation*
- *Wealthy Jews, "violators of the covenant", support Antiochus*
- *Bitterly opposed by the Hassidim, "the people who know their God"*

Interpreting the Arrogant King

Daniel 11:36-45

Maccabean View

- *Stresses continuity between with the "contemptuous king" of 11:21 and the "king" of 11:36*
- *Hence, 11:36-39 continues to describes the career of Antiochus IV Epiphanes*
- *11:40-45 mistakenly predicts events that never materialized:*
  - *Antiochus IV staged his final campaign in Persia, not Egypt, where he died in 164 BC.*
  - *He did not invade Palestine again.*

Eschatological View

- *The continuation of the predictions take the reader to the "time of the end" (11:40), which includes the resurrection of the dead and the last judgment (12:1-3).*
- *Either Daniel conflates the figure of Antiochus IV with the eschatological anti-christ or leaves Antiochus IV altogether.*
- *According to Christ, the desolating sacrilege is not exhausted in the 2nd century BC (Mt. 24:15//Mk. 13:14).*

"…at that time…"

Daniel 12:1

Maccabean View

- *The great "distress" (12:1a) refers to the desecration of the temple by Antiochus IV.*
- *Daniel's "people" refer to the Jews who were persecuted by Antiochus IV.*
- *The "deliverance" (12:1b) and "resurrection" (12:2-3) metaphorically refers to the triumph of the Maccabees.*

Eschatological View

- *The great "distress" (12:1) refers either to Titus' destruction of Jerusalem or to a great tribulation at the end of the age (Mt. 24:21; Mk. 13:19).*
- *Daniel's "people" refer either to all the people of faith (messianic view) or the Jewish people at the end of the age (dispensational view).*
- *The "resurrection" (12:2-3) refers to the resurrection of the dead at the end of the age.*

The "Time, Times and Half a Time"

Daniel 12:7; cf. 7:25

Maccabean View

- *The "time, times and half a time" is the period of the temple's desecration by Antiochus IV (168-164 BC).*
- *1290 days (12:11) are a correction to the original prediction of 1150 days of desecration (cf. 8:14).*
- *The 1335 days (12:12) are yet another correction, this time correcting the 1290 days.*

Eschatological View

- *The "time, times and half a time" is the period of great tribulation at the end of the age (Rv. 11:2-3; 12:6, 14; 13:5).*
- *Dispensationalists also equate it with the last half of Daniel's 70th week.*
- *The 1290 days and the 1335 days (12:11-12) are cryptic numbers for which no completely satisfactory explanation is available.*

POSSIBLE CORRELATIONS

HORN	ABOMINATION	MAN of SIN	ANTI-CHRIST	BEAST
Da. 7:8, 24-25	*Da. 11:31; 12:1a; Mt. 24:15; Mk. 13:14*	*2 Th. 2:3-4, 9-10a*	*1 Jn. 2:22; 4:3; 2 Jn. 7*	*Rv. 13:5-8, 11-17*
Arrogance		Claims deity		Demands worship
Blasphemes	Stands in the Holy Place	Sits in God's temple	Denies God and Jesus Christ	Blasphemes
	Performs miracles	Performs miracles		Performs miracles
Persecutes God's people	Persecutes God's people			Persecutes God's people
	Arch-deceiver	Arch-deceiver		
Aggression				World power
Time, times & ½ time				42 months, 1260 days

Traditional Tomb of Daniel, Susa, Iran